

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 869

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION urging the United States Congress to reinstate mandatory country of origin labeling for all meat.

WHEREAS, American farmers and ranchers raise the best meat in the world; and

WHEREAS, Americans should have the right to knowingly buy made-in-America products; and

WHEREAS, American farmers, ranchers, workers, and consumers benefit from transparency on the origins of their food; and

WHEREAS, consumers have repeatedly and overwhelmingly expressed their support for country of origin labeling of food products in the United States; and

WHEREAS, in 2008, the United States Congress overwhelmingly passed mandatory country of origin labeling for muscle cuts and ground meat sold at retail, requiring meat produced from imported livestock or imported boxed meat to bear a different label from meat produced from livestock born, raised, and slaughtered in the United States; and

WHEREAS, trade groups and the organizations representing multinational meat packers worked predominantly with Canada, as well as Mexico, to bring a World Trade Organization case against the United States for the removal of the country of origin labeling requirements; and

WHEREAS, in 2015, the United States Congress repealed the country of origin labeling law for beef and pork, reducing the competitive advantage of products born, raised, and slaughtered in the United States; and

WHEREAS, the United States has the highest food safety standards in the world, while other countries place less emphasis on food safety; and

WHEREAS, foreign commodities such as beef and pork are misleadingly labeled "Product of the USA" if they are processed or packed in the United States; and

WHEREAS, country of origin labeling gives producers and consumers the ability to distinguish true American products from foreign imported meat; and

WHEREAS, technological advancements make it possible to accurately and efficiently identify the origins of beef and pork without costly separation of imported and domestic commodities; and

WHEREAS, country of origin labeling is good for farmers, ranchers, workers, and meat packers because it allows them to identify their products as born, raised, and slaughtered in the United States; and

WHEREAS, the General Assembly supports American products, and consumers deserve the right to know the origins of their food; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that this General Assembly supports the right of U.S. consumers to know the origins of their food, supports the use of country of origin labels, and urges the United States Congress to enact legislation reinstating mandatory country of origin labeling for all meat.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that a certified copy of this resolution be transmitted to the President and the Secretary of the U.S. Senate, the Speaker and the Clerk of the U.S. House of Representatives, and each member of Tennessee's delegation to the U.S. Congress.